

festival People's Playpen

DELHI It's festival time in the capital. Sanjha Safar, a five-day celebration from November 3 to 7, features a series of multi-disciplinary activities including public hearings, dialogues, children and youth parliaments, panchayats, exhibitions, live performances, fine art displays and an evocative sale of rural arts and food craft. Conceived and implemented by the Asian Heritage Foundation, the festival has been put together by designer-scenographer Rajeev Sethi. It is a participatory festival for the common man. The Hari Dhara Chaupal will be a focal point of the exhibition. It is an art installation that will serve as a chowk where performances, intimate baithaks and daily invocation ceremonies will be held without hindering visitor movement. The installation allows for daily additions—visitors will tie various pre-prepared or impromptu-designed talismans on a tree, writing their messages and wishes on them, making it grow

through public participation.

For food lovers there is Sanjha Chulha, a form of food court. The 60 food stalls attempt to create awareness through the display and sale of an array of regional cuisine showcasing the culinary diversity of the subcontinent. Curated by Navdanya, these stalls bring together participants from different parts of the country, allowing visitors to sample authentic cuisines of different communities presented in a traditional manner. The Beej Manch and the Rasoi Chowk will provide spaces for discussions, performances and gatherings on various food and water related issues. Folk artistes, street performers, balladeers, acrobats and magicians will animate the various areas. The festival will also include performances by IPTA, Mass Player, Bhumika (Delhi), choir singing by the Gandharva Mahavidyalaya and fusion music by Mrigya. At the Rajpath Lawns, opposite Vigyan Bhavan. Be there for an experience to remember and treasure.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

SOULFUL EXPERIENCE: Members of the fusion music band Mrigya ready to amuse crowds at the festival

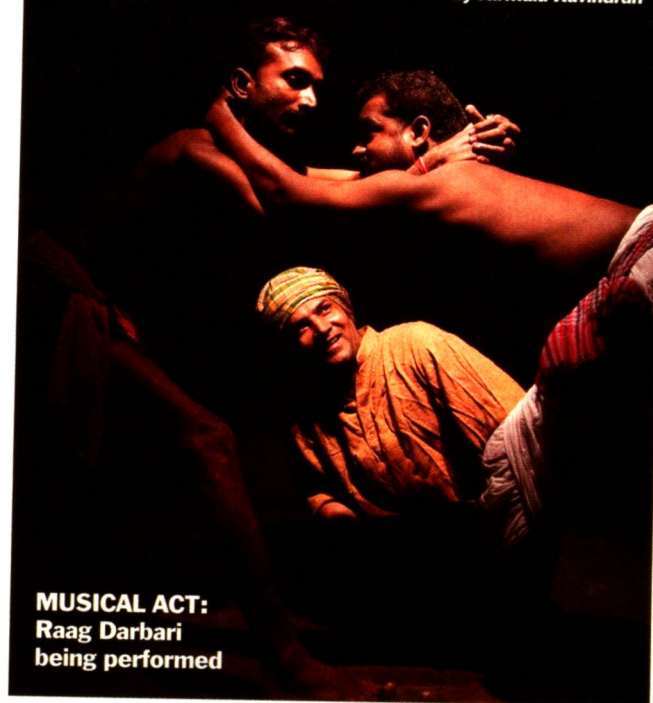


YASBANT NEGI

theatre High Drama

MUMBAI Prithvi Theatre Festival has returned with Mumbai Musicals this time. The festival features a variety of ancillary events besides musicals like book releases, daily platforms, lecture demonstrations on music and dance in theatre and interaction with the directors and playwrights. The plays set to be performed are *Raag Darbari*; *Me Grandad'ad An Elephant*; *Giribala*; *Girija ke Sapne*; *Jazz*; *Nisa Kehte Hain* and *Tukra's Dream*. The most anticipated play is *Mastana Rampuri Urf. Chappan Churi*; an adaptation of *Mac the Knife*. Watch out for daily performances to which entry is free like Lavani, Punjab folk songs, natya sangeet and youth bands from Mumbai. From November 1 to 14.

by Nirmala Ravindran



MUSICAL ACT:
Raag Darbari
being performed

art Iconic Images

CHENNAI Renowned art historian Naman Ahuja will be speaking at the Prakriti Foundation about the Images of a Forgotten Pantheon and the "startling new discoveries of the earliest Indian images and take us into the private worlds of ancient Indians, their myths and icons, gods and demons" on November 4 at Subhiksha, 6 p.m. Two days later, head out to the



Lychee Lassi

Museum Theatre, where Goethe Institute, Max Mueller Bhavan and the Prakriti Foundation are co-organising an evening of electronic music by Lychee Lassi, Germany and Jalebee Cartel. The concert begins at 7 p.m. Entry to both events is free.

by Akhila Krishnamurthy